

כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד בָּלֵב (19:2), possibly the most beautiful pasuk in the Torah. רש"י comments that, however, people often overlook the next pasuk: וּמֹשֶׁה עָלָה אֶל הָאֱלֹקִים. The ספר דרש והעיון, quoted in מעינה של תורה, offers a profound insight: if כלל ישראל achieves this tremendous אחדות and can stand against the יצר הרע, symbolized by a הר, then their leaders, like משה, can ascend higher, reaching the הקדוש ברוך הוא. ומֹשֶׁה עָלָה אֶל הָאֱלֹקִים. He was able to rise higher because of them.

This ascension represents a new challenge. Each step in life, whether in success or failure, presents challenges. When we fail, the challenge is to overcome and improve - through תשובה, תפלה, צדקה, or other means. However, when we succeed, the challenge is not to rest on our laurels. Instead, we should use success as a springboard to elevate ourselves further, continually striving to reach greater heights. Reflecting on the infinite nature of the הקדוש ברוך הוא and the spiritual heights reached by גדולים like משה, רב קהתי, and the Vilna Gaon, we realize the potential within us. Even a simple bank teller like רבי אברהם אביש, demonstrating that ordinary people can reach extraordinary spiritual levels.

This theme ties into an enlightened teaching quoted by R' Matis Blum זצ"ל (known for his תורה לדעת sheets), from the sefer חנוכת התורה החדש. He references a Gemara in שבת פ"ב ע"ב: שבת פה ע"ב - בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁעָלָה מֹשֶׁה לְמָרוֹם: שבת פה ע"ב - אָמְרוּ מַלְאכֵי הַשָּׁרָת לְפָנֵי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא; שמים - מלאכי השרת, who serve before Hashem, complained. Why is a בשר ודם, a person born of flesh and blood, coming here amongst us? אָמַר לָהֶן הוּא - He came to accept the תורה, to receive the תורה. They responded with the pasuk in תהילים (8:2): תִּנֵּה הוֹדֶךָ עַל הַשָּׁמַיִם - Leave it up here with us. So what did Hashem do? He didn't say yes or no. He turned to משה and he said תְּשׁוּבָה - Answer them. That's how we translate it. Give them a תשובה, an answer. So משה רבינו said an astounding thing to Hashem: אֲחוּזוֹ בְּכֶסֶד כְּבוֹדִי וְחֲזוֹר לָהֶן תְּשׁוּבָה - I am terrified. I am scared that they are going to burn me up with their fiery breath. So Hashem said אֲחוּזוֹ בְּכֶסֶד כְּבוֹדִי וְחֲזוֹר לָהֶן תְּשׁוּבָה - Hang on to my כסא הכבוד and give them תשובה.

The entire interaction in this Gemara is astounding. What is happening here? What does this שְׁקָלָא וְטָרְיָא reveal? What were the מלאכים asking, and how did משה רבינו respond?

On a basic level, we know the story: the מלאכים opposed the תורה being given to humanity. However, the חנוכת התורה החדש provides a deeper insight. The מלאכים argued that Man, inherently driven by a strong יצר הרע, would inevitably commit עבירות and neglect the תורה. They believed that leaving the תורה in שמים would be more appropriate. Hashem's response to משה, תשובה, meant not only to provide an answer, but also to highlight the concept of תשובה itself. Through תשובה, a person can rectify עבירות. However, משה expressed fear, שָׁמָּה יִשְׂרָפוּנִי בְּהֶבֶל שְׂבָפִיקָהּ. משה was still concerned about the מלאכים's spiritual superiority and purity, as they are free from עבירות and exist in complete טהרה.

Hashem's instruction to משה, אֲחוּזוֹ בְּכֶסֶד כְּבוֹדִי, symbolizes the profound idea that תשובה can elevate a person to incredible heights. As חז"ל teach, כסא הכבוד עד כסא הכבוד, placing משה רבינו on a higher מדרגה than those who never sinned. This is difficult for us to fully grasp, but it emphasizes the transformative power of תשובה.

The next pasuk in תהילים (8:3) says, מִפִּי עוֹלָלִים וְיִנְקִים יִסְדֶּתָּ עוֹ, משה רבינו told the מלאכים, "I have an answer for you. I can hold on to the כסא הכבוד and reach a higher level than you." The מלאכים dismissed this, arguing, "We don't buy it. We're on a higher level because we have no עבירות. We are completely sin-free, pure in every aspect. Your נשמה is stained by עבירות." In response, משה רבינו confidently countered, "No, I can still surpass you. How? Through the טָהוֹר שְׂבָפִיקָהּ - the pure words of רבן, our תינוקות של בית רבן, קינדערלאך." Another famous מדרש reinforces this idea: when the מלאכים initially resisted the תורה being given to us, various guarantees were proposed - the אבות, the אמהות - but the מלאכים remained



unconvinced. But when they promised תינוקות של בית רבן, the קינדערלאך, the מלאכים accepted them as guarantors and allowed us to get the תורה. When we promise that we'll teach our קינדערלאך and they will be able to learn תורה in purity without any עבירות, that is the הבל.

We have both the בעלי תשובה and the הבל שבפיהם. That's what the pasuk says מְפִי עוֹלָלִים וְיִנְקִים יִסְדֶּתָּ עוֹ - The תורה are the answer to the מלאכים and enable to receive the תורה. Im Yirtzeh Hashem, in the זכות of קבלת תורה, may we all be זוכה to do תשובה and return back to being עוֹלָלִים וְיִנְקִים. Let us all be קינדערלאך in our childlike acceptance of הקדוש ברוך הוא with complete אמונה and בטחון. In that זכות, let משיח come quickly and everyone should have נחמות ונחמות.

